Oberseminar Data Science

Topic Presentation — Winter Semester 2026/27

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Chair of Data Science · University of Passau

The Oberseminar

The entry point for **Bachelor's and Master's theses** at the chair.

- **Topic presentation** — twice a semester (today)
- **Monday sessions** — students present their topic, progress and final results
- **Who attends** — students looking for a topic and students writing their thesis

No-gos

- theses with companies
- topics outside the defined list or the open themes
- topics unrelated to the chair's research

Leave today with one topic in mind — and know what to do next.

Thesis Process

Pick
a defined or open topic

→

Learn
read, discuss on Mondays

→

Exposé
4–6 pages

→

Present
at the Oberseminar

→

Register
starts the clock

Entry task — optional

Some supervisors assign a short entry task. With Prof. Granitzer, the entry phase is the **Monday meeting**: we discuss the topic until it fits.

Registration is binding

Only after the exposé is accepted. A Master's thesis is due **six months** after registration; Bachelor's theses have a shorter period.

Topics

	Defined topics	Open topics
What	specified by the chair	your own research question
Areas	see the list	**Agentic AI**, **Retrieval**, **AI** — nothing else
Platforms	stated per topic	ideally OpenWebIndex.eu, ourrs.eu, yoars.org
Start	read the brief	bring a one-page research question

All defined topics with research questions and approach: **aaire.eu/teaching/theses**

Speaker notes

Selection is not guaranteed. It is based on affinity to the chair — courses taken, grades and the quality of the discussion or one-pager. For open topics a topic area is not enough: the one-pager names a concrete research question, why the student is suited to it, and a plausible evaluation. OUR²S API access: ourrs.eu/developers, login via B2ACCESS with University of Passau credentials.

Monday Meetings

Monday, 14:00–16:00 — presentation slots are listed in Stud.IP *Abschlussarbeiten*.

- ✓ come **every 2–3 weeks** during the semester
- ✓ be ready to **explain your work** so far
- ✓ come **prepared with questions**

Contact

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Read the topic brief before you come — the meeting is for scope and questions, not for retelling the brief.

The Exposé

Section	Content
Motivation	why the problem matters now
State of the art	what exists, where it falls short
Research questions	at least three, specific and answerable
Methodology	data, metrics, baselines, tools
Work plan	3–5 milestones with dates
Limitations	constraints and threats to validity

Limitations are mandatory

A plan without stated limitations shows the scope is not yet understood.

A research question, not a project description. Code and data in Git from day one; writing in English.

Next Steps

1. **Pick** one topic on /teaching/theses/ — or an open topic in Agentic AI, Retrieval or AI
2. **Read and learn** — papers and platform docs, until you have an idea of what to do
3. **Come on Monday** at 14:00 with questions; return every 2–3 weeks until the topic fits
4. **Write the exposé** and present it at the Oberseminar
5. **Register** the thesis

> Your next step is reading: go deep enough into the topic to propose what you want to do.